

A daily scan of national and South Yorkshire developments in education policy, inclusion, SEND, behaviour and accountability — weighted to primary and evidence sources, with links and a clear “so what for your school” line on the items that matter.

Useful? Forward it to a colleague. To join the circulation or partner with the network, [get in touch](#).

TOP LINE

- The OECD's Education at a Glance 2026, published yesterday, confirms England as one of the worst performers on teacher attrition — about 10% left the profession in the latest year, and over 90% of leavers quit voluntarily before retirement, the highest share of any comparator country.
- A new statutory Information Sharing Duty comes into force today under the Children's Wellbeing and Schools Act 2026, requiring schools to proactively share safeguarding-relevant information with other agencies.

→ **For your school:** Check your DSL knows the duty is live from today and has read the statutory guidance.

DATES FOR THE DIARY

30 Sep 2026 — Labour's conference closes in Liverpool; the new Information Sharing Duty statutory guidance takes effect for all schools and colleges.

22 Oct 2026 — NEU national executive reconvenes to decide whether to relaunch the paused strike ballot.

■ OECD CONFIRMS ENGLAND'S TEACHER EXODUS

▪ **England's teacher attrition rate laid bare in new OECD data.** Education at a Glance 2026, published yesterday, shows around 10% of England's teachers left the profession in the latest year measured — over three times the rate in France or Ireland — and more than 90% of those leavers quit voluntarily before retirement, the highest such share in the comparison group. Separate OECD figures show English primary teachers' real-terms pay fell 3.6% between 2015 and 2024. ([OECD](#))

→ **For your school:** Useful external context for SLT/governors if retention comes up in exit interviews or a staff survey this term.

■ SAFEGUARDING: NEW DUTY LIVE TODAY

▪ **Information Sharing Duty statutory guidance takes effect today.** Under the Children's Wellbeing and Schools Act 2026, schools and colleges now have a proactive legal duty to share information relevant to a child's safeguarding or welfare with other agencies, unless sharing would be more harmful than staying silent — aimed at removing the 'better not to share' reflex inquiries have repeatedly flagged. ([LGfL safeguarding briefing](#))

→ **For your school:** Make sure your DSL has read the guidance and it's referenced in your child protection policy before the next review.

■ SHEFFIELD: THE ODDS OF A SUCCESSFUL APPEAL

▪ **Nearly 1 in 3 Sheffield secondary appeals succeeded this year — but the rate is falling.** Of 358 Sheffield households who appealed a Year 7 place for September 2026, 73 succeeded — a 29.3% success rate, down from 35.3% the year before and well below high-success outliers like Sunderland (88.4%). Figures reported via The Star from official DfE admission appeals statistics. ([The Star](#))

→ **For your school:** *If you support families through admissions, the falling success rate is worth flagging — a strong, well-evidenced first preference matters more this year.*

JARGON-BUSTER - INFORMATION SHARING DUTY

New from today under the Children's Wellbeing and Schools Act 2026.

A proactive legal duty on schools and named agencies to share safeguarding-relevant information with each other, rather than only responding to requests — unless sharing would cause more harm than staying silent.

MAPS IN PRACTICE – TOOL SPOTLIGHT: SCHOOL+

A strong inclusion strategy is only as good as the cohort picture beneath it.

School+ is the MAPs cohort-vulnerability framework — it maps who your at-risk pupils are and why, giving your inclusion strategy an evidence base rather than a wish list. [Explore School+](#)

SOURCES MONITORED

Weighted official- and evidence-first. X is monitored for early signals from official accounts and named commentators, and corroborated against a primary source before anything is included.

Source	Type	What we track
OFFICIAL & STATUTORY		
DfE / GOV.UK	Government	Policy, funding, statutory guidance and statistics
Ofsted	Government	Inspection framework, report cards, annual report
Explore Education Statistics	Government data	Exclusions, suspensions, attendance, census data
House of Commons Library	Parliament	Neutral briefings on bills and policy
RESEARCH & EVIDENCE		
Education Endowment Foundation	Research	Evidence-based guidance, incl. inclusive teaching
NFER	Research	Assessment, workforce, disadvantage
Education Policy Institute	Think tank	Policy analysis and the disadvantage gap
Institute for Fiscal Studies	Think tank	School funding and spending analysis
FFT Education Datalab	Data analysis	Data-driven analysis of attainment and exclusions
INCLUSION & PREVENTION SPECIALISTS		
The Difference	Charity	Whole-school inclusion; "Who's Losing Learning?"
IPPR	Think tank	Lost learning, exclusions, SEND reform
Youth Endowment Fund	Research	What works to prevent youth violence & exclusion
Centre for Social Justice	Think tank	Exclusion tracker and social-mobility policy
Whole School SEND	Network	SEND practice, resources and reviews
SECTOR PRESS & COMMENTARY		
Schools Week	Press	Breaking sector news and investigations
Tes	Press	Practice, policy and workforce
The Guardian (Education)	Press	National coverage and comment
X (monitored)	Social	DfE, Ofsted, EEF and named voices — corroborated before use
LOCAL & REGIONAL		
The Star (Sheffield)	Local press	Local schools and Ofsted outcomes
Sheffield City Council	Local government	Council decisions, funding and local strategy
South Yorkshire MCA & Careers Hub	Regional	Regional skills, careers and funding

Connect Daily is part of Sheffield Connect. Compiled by Andy Marsden, Sector Inclusion Lead.

For circulation across the network and partners. Figures reflect the latest published data at the date of this brief.